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Chapter 1

defensive

1.1 overcall

1.1.1 simple

When unfavorable (or V, by judgement), we'll overcall sounder (the "traditional": either good suit with strong LD value, or 11+). Otherwise, we may overcall light with disruptive purpose.

```
# if balancing against pre, may be lighter
# for upper limit, see t/o
1X = 8-18, 5+X # may be weak disruptive, depends on position and Vul
1N = (14)15-18, usually promises stopper.
2X = 10-15, 6+X; 12-18, 5+X.
3X = (13)14+, 6+X; 15+, 5+X
jump 3Y against 2X pre = 16-18, good 6+Y
```

1.1.2 unusual

```
# 10-16, PH ON but may be a Q lighter
(1M) - 2M = 5+oM, 5+m # resp same as 2oM opening
(1M) - 2N = 55+m
(1m) - 2m = 55+M
    cue = inv+ or SI (back to 3H if min)
    2N = nat inv
    others = s/o
(1m) - 2N = 5+H, 5+om
    cue = inv+ H
(2M) - 4m = 5+oM, 5+m # Leaping Michaels
(2D) - 4C = some 5+M, 5+C
```

1.1.3 high level

```
(4m) - 4N = nat.
(4M) - 4N = minors or some 5-5.
(1m) - 3m = nat. (unless 1D = unbal)
(1M/2M) - 3M = Western cuebid. ask stop
```

1.1.4 balancing

system ON for now

1.1.5 sandwich

```
(1X) - P - (1Y) -
    1N = nat
    2X = nat (Rubens from 2Y)
    2Y = nat (no Rubens)
    after X or overcall: Y is the cuebid suit
(1X) - (2X) - 2N = unusual
(1X) - (1N) - X = t/o to X
```

1.2 t/o

```
minimum take out at 1-level: # style: slightly emphasizes major
4333: 13+
4432: 11+, 43+M or 4+oM
1-card opp's suit: 10+ outside
0-card opp's suit: 9+ outside

at 2-level: +2
at 3-level: +4
may be slightly sounder if adv will likely need to bid 1-level higher.
```

1.2.1 X then rebid

```
# here min means X then bid's min
non-jump rebid at...
    1-level: 16-19, 5+X
    2-level: 16-19, 5+X
    3-level: 16-19, 6+X; 18-20, 5+X
cue = stronger than above # if interfered, may use X = re-t/o
```

```

jump / double jump = similar range (can be slightly higher) but 6+X and
    Loser oriented
raise to 2-level = 15-18

```

1.2.2 high level t/o style

We use double very "elasticly":

- at 4S+, tend to show a strong (s)bal with good defensive tricks
- however, may also be hands that promises transferable strength, allowing partner to bid with good shape. An example is -.AQJxx.Axxx.KTxx. With stronger values, you will bid 4N for t/o.
- X to 4H tend to be more t/o-ish, compare to X to 4S+

1.3 advances

1.3.1 simple overcall (Rubens)

We use Rubens advances after 1X - overcall $\leq$ 2D. The rule is: transfer from opp's suit (skipping 2N), until 2X or 3X (direct raise).

```

(1X) - 1Y - (P)
1N = 9-11(12) nat NF, may be lighter (trying to correct contract) if
    short. sounder if partner PH.
2N = (12)13-14(15), nat inv NF # PH: mixed raise
1-suit = F1. usually 5 but may be 4.
2-suit = nat, F1, 10+
    then cue = inv+ F1, other under 2Y = nat and not promising extra
    raise = min fit
jump 2-suit = weak.
jump 3-suit = (12)13-14, nat 6+suit inv # fit-showing if PH
jump cue = mixed raise
transfer from opp's suit (2X): 10+; or 8+ with 6+ suit # 12+ promises
rebid
    transfer accepted = not max (13-)
        transfer than back to 2X = 10-13 NF, exactly 2-fit
        transfer than back to 3X = GF, 3+ fit (like 2/1)
        transfer than 2N = same as direct 2N, but with side suit
    raise = fit inv NF
    new suit = F1
    rebid = mid nat NF
    others = nat
transfer to 2Y = 10+ fit

```

```

(1Y) - 2X - (P)
2N = nat inv NF # roughly same strength as inv against opening
2W < 2Y = nat, F1, 10+ or 8+ with 6+ suit
    then cue = extra, other under 2Y = nat and not promising extra
    raise = min fit
jump 3-suit = (12)13-14, nat 6+suit inv # fit-showing if PH
transfer from opp's suit (2Y): 10+ (GF promises rebid)
    transfer accepted = min # if X: still ON, P shows slight extra and
    perhaps don't like this suit
    rebid = mild extra but NF # no space here ...
    others = nat and GF
    # transfer than back to 3X = GF, exactly 2-fit
transfer to 3Y = inv+ fit

```

1.3.2 unusual

```

if unusual show M + m => same as 2M pre open
if (1C) - 2C show MMs => same as Landy
if (1D) - 2D show MMs =>
    2N = nat inv NF
    3D = inv with some fit

```

1.3.3 t/o

```

(1suit) - X -
1X = 0-8(9), natrual length # free bid: 4+ with shape, or 6+
    raise: constr, roughly 15-18
2X = 0-8(9), natrual length
jump 2X = 8-9, 5+Z; or (9)10-11, 4+Z
jump 3X = (8)9, 5+X; or 10-11(12), 4+X
double jump = nat inv with shape # not pre!
1N = 9-11
2N = (11)12-13

(1m) - X - cue = any GF; or 44+M inv
    2M = 4+M. raise is the only NF bid
    new suit = usually 5-cards except 2S after 2H
    2D/2N+ = nat and GF. basically shows 16+. # since non-GF must have
    4M.
(1m) - X - jump cue = 54+M, good shape, mixed-raise-ish
(1M) - X - cue = any GF
(1M) - X - jump cue = Western cuebid (?)

at 2-level => (transfer) Leb

```

```

(3M) - X -
cue = some single-suited SI
    lowest suit = min
    4N = extra, waiting
    other new suit = extra, nat rebid
4N = at least two places to play, may have no extra

(3m) - X -
cue = 44+M, pick. or some strong single suit
4N = ask Ace?

```

1.3.4 NT overcall

system ON (note: normal Stayman opp 2N/3N) for now.

1.4 vs 1N

We choose the widely-used multi-Landy, and also consistent with our opening preempt. For responses, see [pre](#).

```

X = at least opp's mid-range
2C = 10+, 54+M; or 8+, 55+M
2D = 6.5-Losers or 10+, some 6+M # stronger hands can 2D then bid 3M
2M = 10+, some 5M4m; or 8+, some 5M5m
2N = nat 55m wide in range
3m = nat. vs strong: wide in range, comp; vs weak: very constructive
    (13-15), inv 3N
3M = nat pre
3N = Gambling 3NT

```

```

(1N) - 2C - (P/X) -
    XX = I have own long suit (not C)
    P = s/o in C
    2N = s/o in D # no specific reasons
    2D = ask 5M, then 2N/3m/3M = NF inv
    3m = nat GF
    3M = constr

```

1.5 interfered

If opps interfere, the responsive bids tend to be competitive and NF. Therefore, X then bid new suit becomes strong and forcing.

1.5.1 simple overcall

```

overcall - (X) -
XX = lead-directing (Hx or Hxx)
if we overcall 1X, then transfer from 1N instead (can be quite weak).
    transfer to opp's suit = 10+ without fit.
no matter we overcall in m or M, 2N = some raise # see "the 2N raise"
otherwise, system ON.

(1X) - overcall - (bid Y) -
if cue (2X) still available: Rubens ON. Otherwise OFF.
X = responsive
cue Y = inv+ and ask stopper
if mixed raise unavailable, 2N = some raise # see "the 2N raise"
bid = can be quite weak with long suit. NF

# notes:
if adv passes, then NT by overcaller is unusual.

```

1.5.2 t/o

```

# if re-doubled:
... (1m) - X - (XX) - P = pen.
... (1M) - X - (XX) - P = pick a suit

# if natrual overcalled:
(1X) - X - (M) -
    X = constr+, nat 4+M
    2M = cuebid. 3M = Western
    2X/3X = nat
otherwise X = responsive

# if transfer overcalled: basically
(1X) - X - (transfer M) -
    X = responsive
    1M/2M/3M = nat
    2X/3X = nat
    # for very strong GF hands that wants to cue instead, I think X or
    P then cue?
otherwise X/cue = responsive emphasizing strength/shape

```

1.5.3 unusual interfered

XX = I have my own suit. Others = same.

1.6 vs high level pre